

✱ **Read the passage carefully and answer Questions.**

✱ **Set 1**

When the old railway station at Devgarh was scheduled for demolition, most residents considered it an inconvenience rather than a loss. The station had not handled a passenger train for nearly fifteen years, and its faded signboard was barely readable. Yet Meera, a retired schoolteacher who lived nearby, believed the building still had a purpose. Every afternoon she sat on the cracked platform and watched children from the surrounding neighbourhood play among the weeds.

One summer, Meera noticed that several of the children had begun bringing schoolbooks to the platform. Their homes were crowded, and the public library was almost five kilometres away. She started helping them with their homework under the shade of the station roof. At first, only three children came. Within a month, there were more than twenty.

The railway authorities eventually agreed to postpone the demolition after Meera submitted a proposal to convert the unused station into a community reading room. Local shopkeepers donated shelves, parents contributed old books, and a carpenter repaired the broken windows. What had once seemed like an abandoned structure slowly became a lively place filled with students every evening.

The project did not solve every problem. There were still too few books, and electricity remained unreliable. Nevertheless, the reading room changed how people viewed the station. It was no longer a reminder of a railway line that had disappeared. It had become evidence that an unused space could acquire a new meaning when a community was willing to invest time and imagination in it.

1. According to the passage, why did Meera begin helping children at the railway station?

- A. She wanted to prevent the railway authorities from closing the station.
- B. The children needed a quiet place to study because their homes were crowded.
- C. She wanted to reopen the railway line for local passengers.
- D. The public library had asked her to conduct classes there.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good as per the passage?

- A. The station had not been used for passenger trains for many years.
- B. Local people contributed materials and services to improve the building.
- C. More children began using the station after Meera started helping them.
- D. The reading room immediately received enough books and reliable electricity.

3. What can be most reasonably inferred from the passage?

- A. Community projects can give neglected places a useful new purpose.
- B. Railway authorities generally oppose community development projects.
- C. Children prefer studying outdoors to studying in libraries.
- D. Retired teachers are more effective than professional librarians.

4. The word "inconvenience" in the first paragraph most nearly means:

- A. a valuable opportunity
- B. a serious financial loss
- C. a minor difficulty or annoyance
- D. an unexpected celebration

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Old railway stations should always be preserved as historical monuments.
- B. Children should study outside their homes whenever possible.
- C. Libraries are unnecessary when communities have unused buildings.
- D. A neglected public space can become valuable when a community works together.

✱ **Set 2**

For years, the farmers of Kalyanpur depended almost entirely on the annual monsoon. During good seasons, their wells remained full and the fields produced enough grain. During weak monsoons, however, the same wells dried quickly, forcing families to buy water or leave their fields uncultivated. Many villagers believed that nothing could be done because rainfall was beyond human control.

A young agricultural officer named Arjun visited the village and suggested a different approach. Instead of trying to increase rainfall, he proposed that the villagers learn to retain more of the rain they already received. He showed them how small check dams, contour trenches and restored ponds could slow the movement of water and allow it to seep into the ground.

The proposal initially met resistance. Some farmers thought the structures would occupy valuable land, while others doubted that traditional methods could make a difference. Arjun therefore suggested a small experiment. Ten farmers agreed to restore an old pond before the next monsoon. When heavy rain arrived, the pond filled rapidly, but the water remained for several months instead of disappearing within days.

The following year, more farmers joined the effort. Several unused wells began holding water for longer periods, and farmers were able to plant a second crop in fields that had previously remained dry. The village did not become independent of the monsoon, but its dependence on unpredictable rainfall was reduced.

The experience changed an important attitude among the villagers. They realized that while they could not control when or how much rain would fall, they could influence what happened to the water after it reached the ground. The solution was not to conquer nature but to work more intelligently with it.

1. What was the central problem faced by the farmers of Kalyanpur?

- A. They lacked suitable seeds for growing grain.
- B. They did not have enough workers to cultivate their fields
- C. Their water supply depended heavily on unpredictable monsoon rainfall.
- D. Their village had no agricultural officer.

2. Which of the following statements is NOT supported by the passage?

- A. Some villagers initially doubted Arjun's proposal.
- B. The village became completely independent of the monsoon.
- C. The restored pond retained water for several months.
- D. More farmers joined the water-conservation effort after the experiment.

3. What does the passage suggest about Arjun's approach?

- A. He attempted to control rainfall through modern technology.
- B. He encouraged farmers to stop cultivating during dry seasons.
- C. He believed traditional water-management methods were useless.
- D. He focused on managing available water more effectively.

4. The phrase "beyond human control" refers to the villagers' belief that:

- A. farming was impossible without government support
- B. rainfall could not be controlled by people
- C. wells could not be repaired
- D. crops could not survive in dry weather

5. What is the main lesson of the passage?

- A. Better management of natural resources can reduce the effects of uncertainty.
- B. Traditional farming should be replaced by modern farming.
- C. Human beings can completely overcome natural limitations.
- D. Farmers should avoid growing crops during the monsoon.

✱ **Set 3**

The museum opened at nine every morning, but the first visitor rarely arrived before ten. For this reason, the staff had become accustomed to beginning the day quietly. They dusted display cases, checked the temperature of the galleries and discussed the previous day's visitors. Among them was Kabir, a young assistant who had recently joined the museum.

One morning, Kabir noticed an elderly man standing outside the closed entrance. The man was holding a small notebook and looking repeatedly at the museum's clock. When Kabir opened the door, the visitor entered immediately and asked to see the gallery containing old maps. Kabir explained that the gallery would open only after the routine inspection was complete.

Instead of becoming impatient, the man smiled and said that he had travelled nearly two hundred kilometres to see one particular map. It had been drawn by his grandfather, who had worked as a surveyor many decades earlier. The map was not famous and was displayed among dozens of other documents, but the visitor had never seen it in person.

Kabir decided to show him the gallery as soon as the inspection was finished. When they finally stood before the map, the man remained silent for several seconds. He then pointed to a small river marked in blue and explained that the river had changed course after a major flood. His grandfather had written a note beside it predicting that the surrounding land would eventually become unsuitable for farming.

Kabir had seen the map many times, but he had never noticed the note. The experience reminded him that museum objects could carry different meanings for different people. To the staff, the map was an archival document. To the visitor, it was a surviving connection to a family member whose work had disappeared from ordinary memory.

1. Why had the elderly visitor travelled a long distance to the museum?

- A. To donate his grandfather's collection of maps.
- B. To meet the museum's director.
- C. To study the history of farming in the region.
- D. To see a particular map made by his grandfather.

2. Which of the following does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. The museum staff usually began their day before many visitors arrived.
- B. The map was one of the most famous documents in the museum.
- C. The visitor had never seen his grandfather's map in person.
- D. The visitor explained the significance of a note written beside a river.

3. What can be inferred about Kabir at the end of the passage?

- A. He became less interested in historical documents.
- B. He decided to become a surveyor like the visitor's grandfather.
- C. He realized that an object's significance can depend on personal experience.
- D. He believed the museum should remove old maps from display.

4. The word "archival" in the final paragraph most nearly means:

- A. related to preserved historical records
- B. connected with modern technology
- C. designed for public entertainment
- D. intended for scientific experiments

5. Which statement best expresses the purpose of the passage?

- A. To explain how museums should organize their galleries.
- B. To show how a seemingly ordinary historical object can hold deep personal meaning.
- C. To describe the professional duties of museum assistants.
- D. To argue that old maps are more useful than modern maps.

✱ **Set 4**

At the edge of a busy city stood a narrow strip of land that had once been used as a dumping ground. For years, plastic bags, broken furniture and construction waste had accumulated there. Most people avoided the area because it smelled unpleasant and appeared unsafe. A group of college students decided to change it.

Their original plan was simple: remove the rubbish and plant trees. However, after speaking to residents, they discovered that the problem was more complicated. The nearby households had no convenient place to dispose of waste, and some residents had begun using the empty land because there was no alternative. The students therefore divided their project into several stages.

First, they persuaded the municipal authorities to place waste-collection bins nearby. Next, they organized weekend clean-up drives and separated recyclable material from other waste. Finally, they created a small green area with native plants that required less water than decorative species. Local residents were invited to help maintain it.

The transformation was gradual. The first few weeks were discouraging because newly planted plants were damaged and rubbish continued to appear. The students responded by putting up simple signs and speaking directly with residents instead of blaming them. Some residents began reporting illegal dumping, while others volunteered to water the plants.

A year later, the land looked entirely different. Children used the green area in the evenings, older residents sat there in the morning, and the number of people using the site as a dumping ground had fallen sharply.

The students had initially believed that cleaning the land would solve the problem. They eventually learned that lasting environmental improvement requires more than physical effort. It also depends on infrastructure, public cooperation and a sense of shared responsibility.

1. What did the students discover after speaking to local residents?

- A. The waste problem was partly caused by the lack of convenient disposal facilities.
- B. The land was privately owned.
- C. Residents wanted the area converted into a parking lot.
- D. The municipal authorities had already solved the waste problem.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good as per the passage?

- A. The students planted native species that needed less water.
- B. Some newly planted plants were damaged during the early weeks.
- C. Local people eventually became involved in maintaining the area.
- D. Residents immediately stopped using the land as a dumping ground.

3. Why did the students speak directly with residents instead of simply blaming them?

- A. They were afraid to contact the municipal authorities.
- B. They wanted to understand the causes of the problem and encourage cooperation.
- C. They wanted residents to pay for the clean-up.
- D. They wanted to stop planting trees in the area.

4. The word "gradual" in the fourth paragraph most nearly means:

- A. sudden and unexpected
- B. expensive and complicated
- C. slow and occurring over time
- D. temporary and uncertain

5. What is the main message of the passage?

- A. Sustainable environmental change requires facilities, cooperation and shared responsibility.
- B. Environmental problems can be solved only by government agencies.
- C. Planting trees is the most effective way to improve cities.
- D. College students should take responsibility for all public spaces.

✱ **Set 5**

When the town's clock stopped working, very few people noticed at first. The clock stood on top of the old municipal building and had been part of the town square for more than seventy years. Its hands had stopped at 4:17 one rainy afternoon, but because most residents now checked the time on their phones, the broken clock seemed unimportant.

Ravi, who owned a small repair shop near the square, thought otherwise. He remembered his grandfather telling him that the clock had once been maintained by a local watchmaker whose workshop stood where Ravi's shop now stood. Curious, Ravi climbed the municipal building with permission and examined the mechanism.

The clock was badly worn, but not beyond repair. Ravi estimated that several small parts needed replacement. The municipality, however, had no budget for restoration. Ravi offered to repair it without charging for his labour if the town could help pay for the materials.

At first, only a few people contributed. Then an unexpected event changed the situation. An old photograph of the town square was displayed in a local newspaper. The photograph showed the same clock surrounded by people celebrating a festival decades earlier. Readers began sending their own photographs and stories about the square. Some remembered meeting friends there; others recalled waiting beneath the clock for buses, relatives or important news.

Within weeks, enough money had been collected to repair the mechanism. When the clock started again, people gathered in the square to watch its hands move. No one needed it to know the time; their phones could do that more accurately. Yet the restored clock had become valuable for another reason. It reminded the town that shared places are not merely functional spaces. They can hold memories that connect different generations.

1. Why did Ravi decide to examine the town clock?

- A. He wanted to install a digital clock in its place.
- B. The municipality hired him to replace the entire clock.
- C. He remembered its connection with his grandfather and the town's history.
- D. He needed the clock for his repair shop.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. The municipality had enough money to restore the clock immediately.
- B. The clock had stopped at 4:17.
- C. Ravi offered to provide his labour without charge.
- D. Residents shared photographs and memories of the town square.

3. What can be inferred from the residents' response to the old photograph?

- A. Residents preferred old photographs to using mobile phones.
- B. Many people had personal memories connected with the clock and the square.
- C. The town planned to stop using modern technology.
- D. Most residents had never noticed the clock before it stopped.

4. The word “restoration” in the third paragraph most nearly means:

- A. removal of an old object
- B. replacement with a modern object
- C. public display of a historical photograph
- D. repair and return to a usable condition

5. What does the restored clock symbolize by the end of the passage?

- A. The superiority of traditional clocks over smartphones.
- B. The importance of repairing every old building in a town.
- C. The way shared public places can preserve collective memories.
- D. The need for towns to reject modern technology.

✧ **Set 6**

For many years, the small town of Nandipur had a weekly market that occupied the central square every Sunday. Farmers brought vegetables, potters displayed their vessels, and local families purchased household goods. As supermarkets and online shopping became more common, the market gradually lost customers. Younger residents especially considered it inconvenient because the stalls opened early and offered little variety.

A group of shopkeepers decided to understand why the market was declining. Instead of simply reducing prices, they asked residents what changes would make them return. Several people suggested better organization, cleaner surroundings and more information about locally produced goods. The shopkeepers then worked with the municipality to mark separate areas for food, handicrafts and household products.

They also introduced a simple system in which customers could learn the names of the farmers who had grown particular vegetables. A few stalls began accepting digital payments, and younger sellers started using social media to announce what would be available each Sunday.

The changes did not restore the market to its former size immediately. However, visitors gradually increased. Some customers came because they valued fresh produce, while others enjoyed meeting producers directly. The market also became a place where older residents and younger visitors interacted more frequently.

The experience showed the shopkeepers that preserving a traditional institution did not necessarily mean refusing change. The market became more useful when its traditional strengths were combined with a few modern practices.

1. Why did the shopkeepers initially ask residents for suggestions?

- A. They wanted to close the market permanently.
- B. They wanted to identify changes that could make the market more attractive.
- C. They wanted to replace local farmers with large retailers.
- D. They wanted to prevent younger residents from visiting supermarkets.

2. Which of the following statements does not hold good as per the passage?

- A. The market had gradually lost customers as shopping habits changed.
- B. The municipality helped organize different sections of the market.
- C. Social media was used by some younger sellers.
- D. Digital payments were introduced at every stall immediately.

3. What may be inferred about the shopkeepers' approach?

- A. They believed traditional markets could survive without any changes.
- B. They considered online shopping harmful to all local businesses.
- C. They tried to combine existing strengths with practical modern methods.
- D. They believed lower prices were the only way to attract customers.

4. The word "declining" in the second paragraph most nearly means:

- A. becoming smaller or less successful
- B. becoming more expensive
- C. becoming more organized
- D. becoming increasingly popular

5. What is the central idea of the passage?

- A. Traditional markets should compete with supermarkets by lowering prices.
- B. Modern technology always destroys traditional institutions.
- C. Young people are no longer interested in local products.
- D. Traditional institutions can remain relevant by adapting to changing needs.

✱ **Set 7**

When the first electric buses appeared on the roads of Lakshmi Nagar, public reaction was mixed. Some passengers appreciated the quieter ride, while others worried that the buses would stop frequently because of limited battery capacity. Drivers were also uncertain about the new vehicles because their maintenance procedures differed from those of conventional buses.

The transport department therefore began with a small pilot programme. Only six electric buses were introduced on routes that covered moderate distances and had charging facilities at their terminals. During the first three months, technicians recorded battery performance, charging time and the number of unexpected delays.

The data revealed that some concerns were justified, but others were exaggerated. The buses did require careful scheduling because charging could not be completed instantly. However, they also experienced fewer mechanical problems related to engines and exhaust systems. Drivers reported that the vehicles were easier to operate in crowded streets because they produced less noise.

Instead of expanding the programme immediately, the department made several adjustments. Charging schedules were revised, drivers received additional training, and maintenance staff were taught to diagnose battery-related problems. After these changes, the number of service interruptions declined.

The pilot programme did not prove that electric buses were suitable for every route. It demonstrated

something more practical: introducing new technology successfully requires testing, measurement and adjustment. The department's willingness to study the early results prevented it from making decisions based solely on either enthusiasm or fear.

1. Why did the transport department begin with only six electric buses?

- A. It wanted to test the technology under controlled conditions.
- B. The city could not afford more buses.
- C. Passengers refused to travel in electric buses.
- D. Drivers had already been trained to operate them.

2. Which of the following does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. Some passenger concerns about charging were reasonable.
- B. Electric buses had fewer certain engine-related mechanical problems.
- C. The pilot programme proved that electric buses were suitable for every route.
- D. Drivers received additional training after the initial trial.

3. What did the pilot programme primarily demonstrate?

- A. New technology should be adopted without delay.
- B. Evidence and adjustment are important when introducing new technology.
- C. Electric buses are always cheaper than conventional buses.
- D. Public transport should avoid technological changes.

4. The word "exaggerated" most nearly means:

- A. carefully measured
- B. completely eliminated
- C. officially approved
- D. made to appear greater than it really was

5. Why did the department revise its charging schedules?

- A. To increase the number of passengers on every route.
- B. To eliminate the need for maintenance staff.
- C. To respond to problems identified during the pilot programme.
- D. To make the buses travel longer without electricity.

✧ **Set 8**

The village of Haripur had a pond at its centre, but for years the pond had been treated as little more than an obstacle. People threw waste into it, cattle entered the water freely, and during the dry season much of its surface became covered with weeds. Older residents remembered a time when the pond had supplied water for household use and supported several kinds of fish.

A science teacher named Leela became interested in restoring it after her students conducted a project on local water sources. The students discovered that the pond still collected rainwater from a large part of the village. If the surrounding drains were cleared and waste was prevented from entering the water, the pond could hold significantly more water.

Leela presented the findings at a village meeting. Some residents were skeptical because earlier attempts to clean the pond had failed. Instead of promising an immediate transformation, Leela

proposed that the students and residents monitor the pond for one year.

The first stage involved removing plastic and clearing blocked channels. Later, the village created a simple boundary to keep cattle away from the deepest section. Native aquatic plants were introduced carefully rather than in large quantities. Every few months, the students measured water levels and recorded changes in the pond's condition.

By the end of the year, the pond retained water for longer and supported more visible aquatic life. The village still faced problems during severe droughts, but the pond was no longer considered useless. More importantly, the students learned that environmental restoration was not a single event. It required observation, patience and repeated decisions based on evidence.

1. What did the students discover about the pond?

- A. It had completely stopped collecting rainwater.
- B. It had always been unsuitable for aquatic life.
- C. It was the main source of drinking water for the entire region.
- D. It could potentially store significant amounts of rainwater if properly maintained.

2. Which statement does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. Some residents were doubtful about the restoration project.
- B. Large quantities of aquatic plants were introduced immediately.
- C. The students monitored the pond over a period of one year.
- D. Measures were taken to prevent cattle from entering the deepest section.

3. Why did Leela avoid promising an immediate transformation?

- A. She knew that environmental restoration would require observation and sustained effort.
- B. She believed the pond could never be restored.
- C. She wanted the students to abandon the project.
- D. She expected the government to take over the project.

4. The word "skeptical" most nearly means:

- A. enthusiastic and confident
- B. careless and irresponsible
- C. doubtful or unconvinced
- D. experienced and knowledgeable

5. What is the main lesson conveyed by the passage?

- A. Environmental projects succeed only when they are completed quickly.
- B. Environmental restoration requires patience, monitoring and evidence-based decisions.
- C. Traditional water sources are always better than modern systems.
- D. Students should be responsible for maintaining all village resources.

✱ **Set 9**

Every evening, the public park in Rajanagar became crowded with walkers, children and street vendors. The park had once been designed as a quiet green space, but increasing use had created several problems. Paths became muddy after rain, some areas were poorly lit, and benches were often occupied for long periods by a small group of regular visitors.

The municipal council initially proposed installing more concrete paths and removing several trees to create additional space. Before approving the plan, however, an urban planning student named Sana suggested conducting a short observation study. She and a group of volunteers recorded how different parts of the park were used during morning, afternoon and evening hours.

Their findings produced an unexpected result. The busiest paths were not necessarily the most useful ones, and several apparently unused areas became crowded at particular times. The volunteers also discovered that many walkers preferred shaded routes even when those routes were slightly longer.

Based on the observations, the council modified its plan. Instead of removing trees, it repaired drainage near existing paths, improved lighting at selected points and created small seating areas in underused sections. Vendors were given designated spaces so that they did not block the main walking routes.

The changes were inexpensive compared with the original proposal. More importantly, they were based on how people actually used the park rather than on assumptions about how the space should be used.

The project demonstrated the value of observation in public planning. A space may appear inefficient when viewed at one moment, but its use can change considerably according to time, weather and the needs of different groups.

1. Why did Sana suggest an observation study?

- A. She wanted to prevent the park from being used by children.
- B. She wanted planning decisions to be based on actual patterns of use.
- C. She wanted to replace the trees with concrete paths.
- D. She wanted to remove all street vendors from the park.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good as per the passage?

- A. Some apparently unused areas became busy at particular times.
- B. Many walkers preferred shaded routes.
- C. The council removed several trees as part of the revised plan.
- D. Vendors were assigned specific spaces.

3. What can be inferred from the passage?

- A. Public spaces should be planned without considering users' behaviour.
- B. Concrete paths are always unsuitable for public parks.
- C. Street vendors are responsible for most problems in public spaces.
- D. Observing a place at different times can reveal patterns that are not immediately obvious.

4. The word “assumptions” in the final paragraph most nearly means:

- A. beliefs accepted without sufficient evidence
- B. measurements taken during an experiment
- C. rules established by authorities
- D. problems caused by poor weather

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Public parks should contain fewer trees and more concrete.
- B. Municipal councils should avoid changing existing parks.
- C. Volunteers are more capable than government officials of managing parks.
- D. Careful observation can lead to more effective and economical public planning.

✧ **Set 10**

At first, the employees of a small publishing company were unhappy when the management introduced a four-day workweek. They had been told that their total weekly hours would be reduced slightly, while salaries would remain unchanged. Some employees feared that the shorter schedule would create pressure because the same amount of work would have to be completed in less time.

During the first month, the company did not assume that the experiment was successful. Managers tracked deadlines, customer complaints and the number of unfinished tasks. Employees were also asked to record which meetings and activities consumed most of their working time.

The results showed that a considerable amount of time was being lost to unnecessary meetings and repeated approvals. The company therefore changed its procedures. Several routine meetings were shortened or replaced with written updates, and employees were given greater authority to make minor decisions without seeking approval.

Productivity initially remained stable, but after the procedural changes it increased modestly. Customer complaints did not rise, and employees reported feeling less exhausted at the end of the working week. Some staff members used their additional day for family responsibilities, while others pursued courses or personal projects.

The management concluded that the shorter workweek itself was not a complete solution. Its effectiveness depended on redesigning the way work was organized. The experiment suggested that reducing working hours can be useful when an organization also identifies and removes activities that consume time without contributing significantly to its goals.

1. Why were some employees initially worried about the four-day workweek?

- A. They expected their salaries to be reduced.
- B. They believed the company would close one day every week.
- C. They feared they would have to complete the same work in less time.
- D. They wanted more meetings and approvals.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. Customer complaints increased substantially after the shorter workweek.
- B. The company monitored the experiment before deciding whether it was successful.
- C. Employees identified meetings and approvals as sources of wasted time.
- D. Some employees used their additional day for personal activities.

3. What was an important reason for the improvement in productivity?

- A. Employees were required to work longer hours on the remaining days.
- B. Managers increased the number of approval stages.
- C. Customers were asked to reduce their expectations.
- D. The company redesigned procedures that had been consuming unnecessary time.

4. The word “modestly” in the third paragraph most nearly means:

- A. suddenly and dramatically
- B. slightly or to a limited extent
- C. permanently and completely
- D. unwillingly and reluctantly

5. What conclusion did management draw from the experiment?

- A. Employees should have no meetings at all.
- B. A shorter workweek is automatically successful in every organization.
- C. Reduced working hours work best when accompanied by better work processes.
- D. Productivity depends mainly on increasing employees' salaries.

1. Read the passage carefully and answer Questions.

✧ **Set 1**

When the old railway station at Devgarh was scheduled for demolition, most residents considered it an inconvenience rather than a loss. The station had not handled a passenger train for nearly fifteen years, and its faded signboard was barely readable. Yet Meera, a retired schoolteacher who lived nearby, believed the building still had a purpose. Every afternoon she sat on the cracked platform and watched children from the surrounding neighbourhood play among the weeds.

One summer, Meera noticed that several of the children had begun bringing schoolbooks to the platform. Their homes were crowded, and the public library was almost five kilometres away. She started helping them with their homework under the shade of the station roof. At first, only three children came. Within a month, there were more than twenty.

The railway authorities eventually agreed to postpone the demolition after Meera submitted a proposal to convert the unused station into a community reading room. Local shopkeepers donated shelves, parents contributed old books, and a carpenter repaired the broken windows. What had once seemed like an abandoned structure slowly became a lively place filled with students every evening.

The project did not solve every problem. There were still too few books, and electricity remained unreliable. Nevertheless, the reading room changed how people viewed the station. It was no longer a reminder of a railway line that had disappeared. It had become evidence that an unused space could acquire a new meaning when a community was willing to invest time and imagination in it.

1. According to the passage, why did Meera begin helping children at the railway station?

- A. She wanted to prevent the railway authorities from closing the station.
- B. The children needed a quiet place to study because their homes were crowded.**
- C. She wanted to reopen the railway line for local passengers.
- D. The public library had asked her to conduct classes there.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good as per the passage?

- A. The station had not been used for passenger trains for many years.
- B. Local people contributed materials and services to improve the building.
- C. More children began using the station after Meera started helping them.
- D. The reading room immediately received enough books and reliable electricity.**

3. What can be most reasonably inferred from the passage?

- A. Community projects can give neglected places a useful new purpose.**
- B. Railway authorities generally oppose community development projects.
- C. Children prefer studying outdoors to studying in libraries.
- D. Retired teachers are more effective than professional librarians.

4. The word "inconvenience" in the first paragraph most nearly means:

- A. a valuable opportunity
- B. a serious financial loss
- C. a minor difficulty or annoyance**
- D. an unexpected celebration

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Old railway stations should always be preserved as historical monuments.
- B. Children should study outside their homes whenever possible.
- C. Libraries are unnecessary when communities have unused buildings.
- D. A neglected public space can become valuable when a community works together.**

✱ **Set 2**

For years, the farmers of Kalyanpur depended almost entirely on the annual monsoon. During good seasons, their wells remained full and the fields produced enough grain. During weak monsoons, however, the same wells dried quickly, forcing families to buy water or leave their fields uncultivated. Many villagers believed that nothing could be done because rainfall was beyond human control.

A young agricultural officer named Arjun visited the village and suggested a different approach. Instead of trying to increase rainfall, he proposed that the villagers learn to retain more of the rain they already received. He showed them how small check dams, contour trenches and restored ponds could slow the movement of water and allow it to seep into the ground.

The proposal initially met resistance. Some farmers thought the structures would occupy valuable land, while others doubted that traditional methods could make a difference. Arjun therefore suggested a small experiment. Ten farmers agreed to restore an old pond before the next monsoon. When heavy rain arrived, the pond filled rapidly, but the water remained for several months instead of disappearing within days.

The following year, more farmers joined the effort. Several unused wells began holding water for longer periods, and farmers were able to plant a second crop in fields that had previously remained dry. The village did not become independent of the monsoon, but its dependence on unpredictable rainfall was reduced.

The experience changed an important attitude among the villagers. They realized that while they could not control when or how much rain would fall, they could influence what happened to the water after it reached the ground. The solution was not to conquer nature but to work more intelligently with it.

1. What was the central problem faced by the farmers of Kalyanpur?

- A. They lacked suitable seeds for growing grain.
- B. They did not have enough workers to cultivate their fields
- C. Their water supply depended heavily on unpredictable monsoon rainfall.**
- D. Their village had no agricultural officer.

2. Which of the following statements is NOT supported by the passage?

- A. Some villagers initially doubted Arjun's proposal.
- B. The village became completely independent of the monsoon.**
- C. The restored pond retained water for several months.
- D. More farmers joined the water-conservation effort after the experiment.

3. What does the passage suggest about Arjun's approach?

- A. He attempted to control rainfall through modern technology.
- B. He encouraged farmers to stop cultivating during dry seasons.
- C. He believed traditional water-management methods were useless.
- D. He focused on managing available water more effectively.**

4. The phrase "beyond human control" refers to the villagers' belief that:

- A. farming was impossible without government support
- B. rainfall could not be controlled by people**
- C. wells could not be repaired
- D. crops could not survive in dry weather

5. What is the main lesson of the passage?

- A. Better management of natural resources can reduce the effects of uncertainty.**
- B. Traditional farming should be replaced by modern farming.
- C. Human beings can completely overcome natural limitations.
- D. Farmers should avoid growing crops during the monsoon.

✱ **Set 3**

The museum opened at nine every morning, but the first visitor rarely arrived before ten. For this reason, the staff had become accustomed to beginning the day quietly. They dusted display cases, checked the temperature of the galleries and discussed the previous day's visitors. Among them was Kabir, a young assistant who had recently joined the museum.

One morning, Kabir noticed an elderly man standing outside the closed entrance. The man was holding a small notebook and looking repeatedly at the museum's clock. When Kabir opened the door, the visitor entered immediately and asked to see the gallery containing old maps. Kabir explained that the gallery would open only after the routine inspection was complete.

Instead of becoming impatient, the man smiled and said that he had travelled nearly two hundred kilometres to see one particular map. It had been drawn by his grandfather, who had worked as a surveyor many decades earlier. The map was not famous and was displayed among dozens of other documents, but the visitor had never seen it in person.

Kabir decided to show him the gallery as soon as the inspection was finished. When they finally stood before the map, the man remained silent for several seconds. He then pointed to a small river marked in blue and explained that the river had changed course after a major flood. His grandfather had written a note beside it predicting that the surrounding land would eventually become unsuitable for farming.

Kabir had seen the map many times, but he had never noticed the note. The experience reminded him that museum objects could carry different meanings for different people. To the staff, the map was an archival document. To the visitor, it was a surviving connection to a family member whose work had disappeared from ordinary memory.

1. Why had the elderly visitor travelled a long distance to the museum?

- A. To donate his grandfather's collection of maps.

- B. To meet the museum's director.
- C. To study the history of farming in the region.
- D. To see a particular map made by his grandfather.**

2. Which of the following does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. The museum staff usually began their day before many visitors arrived.
- B. The map was one of the most famous documents in the museum.**
- C. The visitor had never seen his grandfather's map in person.
- D. The visitor explained the significance of a note written beside a river.

3. What can be inferred about Kabir at the end of the passage?

- A. He became less interested in historical documents.
- B. He decided to become a surveyor like the visitor's grandfather.
- C. He realized that an object's significance can depend on personal experience.**
- D. He believed the museum should remove old maps from display.

4. The word "archival" in the final paragraph most nearly means:

- A. related to preserved historical records**
- B. connected with modern technology
- C. designed for public entertainment
- D. intended for scientific experiments

5. Which statement best expresses the purpose of the passage?

- A. To explain how museums should organize their galleries.
- B. To show how a seemingly ordinary historical object can hold deep personal meaning.**
- C. To describe the professional duties of museum assistants.
- D. To argue that old maps are more useful than modern maps.

✱ **Set 4**

At the edge of a busy city stood a narrow strip of land that had once been used as a dumping ground. For years, plastic bags, broken furniture and construction waste had accumulated there. Most people avoided the area because it smelled unpleasant and appeared unsafe. A group of college students decided to change it.

Their original plan was simple: remove the rubbish and plant trees. However, after speaking to residents, they discovered that the problem was more complicated. The nearby households had no convenient place to dispose of waste, and some residents had begun using the empty land because there was no alternative. The students therefore divided their project into several stages.

First, they persuaded the municipal authorities to place waste-collection bins nearby. Next, they organized weekend clean-up drives and separated recyclable material from other waste. Finally, they created a small green area with native plants that required less water than decorative species. Local residents were invited to help maintain it.

The transformation was gradual. The first few weeks were discouraging because newly planted plants

were damaged and rubbish continued to appear. The students responded by putting up simple signs and speaking directly with residents instead of blaming them. Some residents began reporting illegal dumping, while others volunteered to water the plants.

A year later, the land looked entirely different. Children used the green area in the evenings, older residents sat there in the morning, and the number of people using the site as a dumping ground had fallen sharply.

The students had initially believed that cleaning the land would solve the problem. They eventually learned that lasting environmental improvement requires more than physical effort. It also depends on infrastructure, public cooperation and a sense of shared responsibility.

1. What did the students discover after speaking to local residents?

- A. The waste problem was partly caused by the lack of convenient disposal facilities.**
- B. The land was privately owned.
- C. Residents wanted the area converted into a parking lot.
- D. The municipal authorities had already solved the waste problem.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good as per the passage?

- A. The students planted native species that needed less water.
- B. Some newly planted plants were damaged during the early weeks.
- C. Local people eventually became involved in maintaining the area.
- D. Residents immediately stopped using the land as a dumping ground.**

3. Why did the students speak directly with residents instead of simply blaming them?

- A. They were afraid to contact the municipal authorities.
- B. They wanted to understand the causes of the problem and encourage cooperation.**
- C. They wanted residents to pay for the clean-up.
- D. They wanted to stop planting trees in the area.

4. The word "gradual" in the fourth paragraph most nearly means:

- A. sudden and unexpected
- B. expensive and complicated
- C. slow and occurring over time**
- D. temporary and uncertain

5. What is the main message of the passage?

- A. Sustainable environmental change requires facilities, cooperation and shared responsibility.**
- B. Environmental problems can be solved only by government agencies.
- C. Planting trees is the most effective way to improve cities.
- D. College students should take responsibility for all public spaces.

✱ **Set 5**

When the town's clock stopped working, very few people noticed at first. The clock stood on top of the old municipal building and had been part of the town square for more than seventy years. Its hands had stopped at 4:17 one rainy afternoon, but because most residents now checked the time on their phones, the broken clock seemed unimportant.

Ravi, who owned a small repair shop near the square, thought otherwise. He remembered his grandfather telling him that the clock had once been maintained by a local watchmaker whose workshop stood where Ravi's shop now stood. Curious, Ravi climbed the municipal building with permission and examined the mechanism.

The clock was badly worn, but not beyond repair. Ravi estimated that several small parts needed replacement. The municipality, however, had no budget for restoration. Ravi offered to repair it without charging for his labour if the town could help pay for the materials.

At first, only a few people contributed. Then an unexpected event changed the situation. An old photograph of the town square was displayed in a local newspaper. The photograph showed the same clock surrounded by people celebrating a festival decades earlier. Readers began sending their own photographs and stories about the square. Some remembered meeting friends there; others recalled waiting beneath the clock for buses, relatives or important news.

Within weeks, enough money had been collected to repair the mechanism. When the clock started again, people gathered in the square to watch its hands move. No one needed it to know the time; their phones could do that more accurately. Yet the restored clock had become valuable for another reason. It reminded the town that shared places are not merely functional spaces. They can hold memories that connect different generations.

1. Why did Ravi decide to examine the town clock?

- A. He wanted to install a digital clock in its place.
- B. The municipality hired him to replace the entire clock.
- C. He remembered its connection with his grandfather and the town's history.**
- D. He needed the clock for his repair shop.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. The municipality had enough money to restore the clock immediately.**
- B. The clock had stopped at 4:17.
- C. Ravi offered to provide his labour without charge.
- D. Residents shared photographs and memories of the town square.

3. What can be inferred from the residents' response to the old photograph?

- A. Residents preferred old photographs to using mobile phones.
- B. Many people had personal memories connected with the clock and the square.**
- C. The town planned to stop using modern technology.
- D. Most residents had never noticed the clock before it stopped.

4. The word “restoration” in the third paragraph most nearly means:

- A. removal of an old object
- B. replacement with a modern object
- C. public display of a historical photograph
- D. repair and return to a usable condition**

5. What does the restored clock symbolize by the end of the passage?

- A. The superiority of traditional clocks over smartphones.
- B. The importance of repairing every old building in a town.
- C. The way shared public places can preserve collective memories.**
- D. The need for towns to reject modern technology.

✧ **Set 6**

For many years, the small town of Nandipur had a weekly market that occupied the central square every Sunday. Farmers brought vegetables, potters displayed their vessels, and local families purchased household goods. As supermarkets and online shopping became more common, the market gradually lost customers. Younger residents especially considered it inconvenient because the stalls opened early and offered little variety.

A group of shopkeepers decided to understand why the market was declining. Instead of simply reducing prices, they asked residents what changes would make them return. Several people suggested better organization, cleaner surroundings and more information about locally produced goods. The shopkeepers then worked with the municipality to mark separate areas for food, handicrafts and household products.

They also introduced a simple system in which customers could learn the names of the farmers who had grown particular vegetables. A few stalls began accepting digital payments, and younger sellers started using social media to announce what would be available each Sunday.

The changes did not restore the market to its former size immediately. However, visitors gradually increased. Some customers came because they valued fresh produce, while others enjoyed meeting producers directly. The market also became a place where older residents and younger visitors interacted more frequently.

The experience showed the shopkeepers that preserving a traditional institution did not necessarily mean refusing change. The market became more useful when its traditional strengths were combined with a few modern practices.

1. Why did the shopkeepers initially ask residents for suggestions?

- A. They wanted to close the market permanently.
- B. They wanted to identify changes that could make the market more attractive.**
- C. They wanted to replace local farmers with large retailers.
- D. They wanted to prevent younger residents from visiting supermarkets.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good as per the passage?

- A. The market had gradually lost customers as shopping habits changed.
- B. The municipality helped organize different sections of the market.
- C. Social media was used by some younger sellers.
- D. Digital payments were introduced at every stall immediately.**

3. What may be inferred about the shopkeepers' approach?

- A. They believed traditional markets could survive without any changes.
- B. They considered online shopping harmful to all local businesses.
- C. They tried to combine existing strengths with practical modern methods.**
- D. They believed lower prices were the only way to attract customers.

4. The word "declining" in the second paragraph most nearly means:

- A. becoming smaller or less successful**
- B. becoming more expensive
- C. becoming more organized
- D. becoming increasingly popular

5. What is the central idea of the passage?

- A. Traditional markets should compete with supermarkets by lowering prices.
- B. Modern technology always destroys traditional institutions.
- C. Young people are no longer interested in local products.
- D. Traditional institutions can remain relevant by adapting to changing needs.**

✱ **Set 7**

When the first electric buses appeared on the roads of Lakshmi Nagar, public reaction was mixed. Some passengers appreciated the quieter ride, while others worried that the buses would stop frequently because of limited battery capacity. Drivers were also uncertain about the new vehicles because their maintenance procedures differed from those of conventional buses.

The transport department therefore began with a small pilot programme. Only six electric buses were introduced on routes that covered moderate distances and had charging facilities at their terminals. During the first three months, technicians recorded battery performance, charging time and the number of unexpected delays.

The data revealed that some concerns were justified, but others were exaggerated. The buses did require careful scheduling because charging could not be completed instantly. However, they also experienced fewer mechanical problems related to engines and exhaust systems. Drivers reported that the vehicles were easier to operate in crowded streets because they produced less noise.

Instead of expanding the programme immediately, the department made several adjustments. Charging schedules were revised, drivers received additional training, and maintenance staff were taught to diagnose battery-related problems. After these changes, the number of service interruptions declined.

The pilot programme did not prove that electric buses were suitable for every route. It demonstrated

something more practical: introducing new technology successfully requires testing, measurement and adjustment. The department's willingness to study the early results prevented it from making decisions based solely on either enthusiasm or fear.

1. Why did the transport department begin with only six electric buses?

A. It wanted to test the technology under controlled conditions.

B. The city could not afford more buses.

C. Passengers refused to travel in electric buses.

D. Drivers had already been trained to operate them.

2. Which of the following does NOT hold good according to the passage?

A. Some passenger concerns about charging were reasonable.

B. Electric buses had fewer certain engine-related mechanical problems.

C. The pilot programme proved that electric buses were suitable for every route.

D. Drivers received additional training after the initial trial.

3. What did the pilot programme primarily demonstrate?

A. New technology should be adopted without delay.

B. Evidence and adjustment are important when introducing new technology.

C. Electric buses are always cheaper than conventional buses.

D. Public transport should avoid technological changes.

4. The word "exaggerated" most nearly means:

A. carefully measured

B. completely eliminated

C. officially approved

D. made to appear greater than it really was

5. Why did the department revise its charging schedules?

A. To increase the number of passengers on every route.

B. To eliminate the need for maintenance staff.

C. To respond to problems identified during the pilot programme.

D. To make the buses travel longer without electricity.

✱ **Set 8**

The village of Haripur had a pond at its centre, but for years the pond had been treated as little more than an obstacle. People threw waste into it, cattle entered the water freely, and during the dry season much of its surface became covered with weeds. Older residents remembered a time when the pond had supplied water for household use and supported several kinds of fish.

A science teacher named Leela became interested in restoring it after her students conducted a project on local water sources. The students discovered that the pond still collected rainwater from a large part of the village. If the surrounding drains were cleared and waste was prevented from entering the water, the pond could hold significantly more water.

Leela presented the findings at a village meeting. Some residents were skeptical because earlier

attempts to clean the pond had failed. Instead of promising an immediate transformation, Leela proposed that the students and residents monitor the pond for one year.

The first stage involved removing plastic and clearing blocked channels. Later, the village created a simple boundary to keep cattle away from the deepest section. Native aquatic plants were introduced carefully rather than in large quantities. Every few months, the students measured water levels and recorded changes in the pond's condition.

By the end of the year, the pond retained water for longer and supported more visible aquatic life. The village still faced problems during severe droughts, but the pond was no longer considered useless. More importantly, the students learned that environmental restoration was not a single event. It required observation, patience and repeated decisions based on evidence.

1. What did the students discover about the pond?

- A. It had completely stopped collecting rainwater.
- B. It had always been unsuitable for aquatic life.
- C. It was the main source of drinking water for the entire region.
- D. It could potentially store significant amounts of rainwater if properly maintained.**

2. Which statement does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. Some residents were doubtful about the restoration project.
- B. Large quantities of aquatic plants were introduced immediately.**
- C. The students monitored the pond over a period of one year.
- D. Measures were taken to prevent cattle from entering the deepest section.

3. Why did Leela avoid promising an immediate transformation?

- A. She knew that environmental restoration would require observation and sustained effort.**
- B. She believed the pond could never be restored.
- C. She wanted the students to abandon the project.
- D. She expected the government to take over the project.

4. The word "skeptical" most nearly means:

- A. enthusiastic and confident
- B. careless and irresponsible
- C. doubtful or unconvinced**
- D. experienced and knowledgeable

5. What is the main lesson conveyed by the passage?

- A. Environmental projects succeed only when they are completed quickly.
- B. Environmental restoration requires patience, monitoring and evidence-based decisions.**
- C. Traditional water sources are always better than modern systems.
- D. Students should be responsible for maintaining all village resources.

✱ **Set 9**

Every evening, the public park in Rajanagar became crowded with walkers, children and street vendors. The park had once been designed as a quiet green space, but increasing use had created several problems. Paths became muddy after rain, some areas were poorly lit, and benches were often occupied for long periods by a small group of regular visitors.

The municipal council initially proposed installing more concrete paths and removing several trees to create additional space. Before approving the plan, however, an urban planning student named Sana suggested conducting a short observation study. She and a group of volunteers recorded how different parts of the park were used during morning, afternoon and evening hours.

Their findings produced an unexpected result. The busiest paths were not necessarily the most useful ones, and several apparently unused areas became crowded at particular times. The volunteers also discovered that many walkers preferred shaded routes even when those routes were slightly longer.

Based on the observations, the council modified its plan. Instead of removing trees, it repaired drainage near existing paths, improved lighting at selected points and created small seating areas in underused sections. Vendors were given designated spaces so that they did not block the main walking routes.

The changes were inexpensive compared with the original proposal. More importantly, they were based on how people actually used the park rather than on assumptions about how the space should be used.

The project demonstrated the value of observation in public planning. A space may appear inefficient when viewed at one moment, but its use can change considerably according to time, weather and the needs of different groups.

1. Why did Sana suggest an observation study?

- A. She wanted to prevent the park from being used by children.
- B. She wanted planning decisions to be based on actual patterns of use.**
- C. She wanted to replace the trees with concrete paths.
- D. She wanted to remove all street vendors from the park.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good as per the passage?

- A. Some apparently unused areas became busy at particular times.
- B. Many walkers preferred shaded routes.
- C. The council removed several trees as part of the revised plan.**
- D. Vendors were assigned specific spaces.

3. What can be inferred from the passage?

- A. Public spaces should be planned without considering users' behaviour.
- B. Concrete paths are always unsuitable for public parks.
- C. Street vendors are responsible for most problems in public spaces.
- D. Observing a place at different times can reveal patterns that are not immediately obvious.**

4. The word “assumptions” in the final paragraph most nearly means:

- A. beliefs accepted without sufficient evidence**
- B. measurements taken during an experiment
- C. rules established by authorities
- D. problems caused by poor weather

5. What is the main idea of the passage?

- A. Public parks should contain fewer trees and more concrete.
- B. Municipal councils should avoid changing existing parks.
- C. Volunteers are more capable than government officials of managing parks.
- D. Careful observation can lead to more effective and economical public planning.**

✧ **Set 10**

At first, the employees of a small publishing company were unhappy when the management introduced a four-day workweek. They had been told that their total weekly hours would be reduced slightly, while salaries would remain unchanged. Some employees feared that the shorter schedule would create pressure because the same amount of work would have to be completed in less time.

During the first month, the company did not assume that the experiment was successful. Managers tracked deadlines, customer complaints and the number of unfinished tasks. Employees were also asked to record which meetings and activities consumed most of their working time.

The results showed that a considerable amount of time was being lost to unnecessary meetings and repeated approvals. The company therefore changed its procedures. Several routine meetings were shortened or replaced with written updates, and employees were given greater authority to make minor decisions without seeking approval.

Productivity initially remained stable, but after the procedural changes it increased modestly. Customer complaints did not rise, and employees reported feeling less exhausted at the end of the working week. Some staff members used their additional day for family responsibilities, while others pursued courses or personal projects.

The management concluded that the shorter workweek itself was not a complete solution. Its effectiveness depended on redesigning the way work was organized. The experiment suggested that reducing working hours can be useful when an organization also identifies and removes activities that consume time without contributing significantly to its goals.

1. Why were some employees initially worried about the four-day workweek?

- A. They expected their salaries to be reduced.
- B. They believed the company would close one day every week.
- C. They feared they would have to complete the same work in less time.**
- D. They wanted more meetings and approvals.

2. Which of the following statements does NOT hold good according to the passage?

- A. Customer complaints increased substantially after the shorter workweek.**

- B. The company monitored the experiment before deciding whether it was successful.
- C. Employees identified meetings and approvals as sources of wasted time.
- D. Some employees used their additional day for personal activities.

3. What was an important reason for the improvement in productivity?

- A. Employees were required to work longer hours on the remaining days.
- B. Managers increased the number of approval stages.
- C. Customers were asked to reduce their expectations.
- D. The company redesigned procedures that had been consuming unnecessary time.**

4. The word "modestly" in the third paragraph most nearly means:

- A. suddenly and dramatically
- B. slightly or to a limited extent**
- C. permanently and completely
- D. unwillingly and reluctantly

5. What conclusion did management draw from the experiment?

- A. Employees should have no meetings at all.
- B. A shorter workweek is automatically successful in every organization.
- C. Reduced working hours work best when accompanied by better work processes.**
- D. Productivity depends mainly on increasing employees' salaries.